than just on the basis of alliance solidarity. Nehru appreciated the US attitude, convinced that Eisenhower did not approve of the invasion.[46]

Eisenhower's portrayal of the US as a reluctant warrior serving on invitation—when it would rather focus internally[47]—also struck a nerve with Nehru. While lamenting the American emphasis on a military approach, he publicly praised Eisenhower as a "great man" of peace and stressed that the US "could do a great deal of good in the world."[48] The US president, on his part, continued to convey to Indian officials like the visiting Indian vice president his reluctance to resort to arms. He also expressed awareness of the damage done to America's image by certain US military actions.[49]

From the US perspective, Nehru also displayed more circumspect behavior on the international stage. Indeed, he was more restrained in offering to mediate or in seeking participation in major conferences. Given India's own "burdens," the prime minister concluded it best to avoid most such entanglements and a crusading or condemnatory attitude. The latter was ineffective and only reduced India's influence.[50]

The greater tolerance toward the other country's approach—and the acknowledgment that the other side meant well—was accompanied by a reduced emphasis on differences. The change was evident in the tone of the Dulles-Nehru discussions in March 1956 and the Eisenhower-Nehru talks later that year. Nehru noted that neither American policymaker had rejected his contentions, but merely pointed out where they differed and explained their reasons.[51] He publicly noted that no two countries had "complete agreement."[52] Privately, Nehru observed that, in many cases, US-India disagreement was exaggerated, and often the difference was one of emphasis.[53] In parliament, Nehru stated that indeed "there are many basic similarities in approach," which were being emphasized more.[54]

The two countries also handled differences in a better way. Disagreements over existing alliances, for example, remained. Nehru believed that the Southeast Asia Treaty Organization and the Central Treaty Organization had exacerbated the problems they had been designed to solve. However, he was careful to add that he was not "trying to run them down" or be "presumptuous enough to criticize," but merely wanted to note that they were counterproductive. Nehru also made sure to include the Warsaw Pact when he discussed the downside of alliances.[55] When the